Wycliffe Associates

Bible Translation Reviewers' Guide

1 Corinthians

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1:10-18

Background: 1 Corinthians is a letter that Paul wrote to the believers who were in the city of Corinth. Paul had heard that there were problems among the believers there. They were arguing with each other. Some of them did not understand some of the Christian teachings. And some of them were behaving badly. In this letter, Paul responded to them and encouraged them to live in a way that pleased God.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul urged the Corinthians to have no divisions among themselves. [1:10]
- ☐ Chloe's people had told Paul that there were divisions among the believers in Corinth. [1:11]
- ☐ Some claimed to follow Paul or Apollos or Cephas or Christ. [1:12]
- ☐ Paul did not want people to think that Christ was divided, or to think that anyone had been baptized in Paul's name. [1:13-15]
- ☐ Christ did not send Paul to baptize but to preach the gospel. [1:17]
- ☐ The message of the cross is foolishness to some, but it is the power of God for those who are being saved. [1:18]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [1:10] What did Paul urge the believers at Corinth to do?
   Paul urged them to all agree with one another. He urged them not to be divided.

2. [1:11] What did Chloe's people report to Paul?
   Chloe's people told Paul that factions had developed among those at Corinth.

3. [1:11-12] What do you think it meant that there were factions in the church?
   This seems to mean that people in the church were divided against each other and that they were arguing with one another.

4. [1:12] What were different people saying in the church at Corinth?
   Different people claimed to follow different Christian leaders, such as Paul, Apollos, Cephas, or Christ.

5. [1:13] What did Paul ask the Corinthians?
   He asked if Christ is divided. He asked the Corinthians whether Paul was crucified for them. He asked if they were baptized into the name of Paul.

6. [1:13] Why do you think that Paul asked these questions?
   The text seems to indicate that Paul used these questions to correct the Corinthian Christians. He seemed to be reminding them that everyone is united in Christ, that Paul was not crucified for them, and that they were not baptized into Paul's name.

1 Corinthians 1:10-18 continued

7. [1:14-15] Why did Paul thank God that he baptized none of them except Crispus and Gaius?
   Paul thanked God for this because that would give people no reason to say that they were baptized into Paul's name.

8. [1:17] What did Christ send Paul to do?
   Christ sent Paul to simply preach the gospel.

9. [1:17] Why did Paul need to preach the gospel without clever words?
   Clever or eloquent speech might put less emphasis on the power of the cross.

10. [1:18] What is the message of the cross to those who are perishing?
    It is foolishness to those who are perishing.

11. [1:18] What is the message of the cross to those who are being saved?
    It is the power of God to those who are being saved.

Comment Section:

2:6-16

Background: In the first part of this passage, Paul spoke about himself along with other preachers of the gospel. In later parts of this passage, Paul spoke about himself along with other believers.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul and others gave a message of God's wisdom to the mature. This is not worldly wisdom, like that of earthly rulers who are passing away. [2:6-7]
- ☐ If the rulers of that time had understood God's hidden wisdom, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory. [2:7-8]
- ☐ Paul quoted scripture saying that no one can imagine the wonderful things that God has made ready for those who love him. [2:9]
- ☐ God reveals these things to believers through the Spirit. [2:10]
- ☐ God's Spirit is the only one who can understand the thoughts of God. [2:10-11]
- ☐ Believers have received the Spirit from God and not the spirit of the world. This makes believers able to understand teaching that uses spiritual words. [2:12-13]
- ☐ An unspiritual person cannot understand spiritual things. [2:14]
- ☐ Believers have the mind of Christ. [2:16]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [2:6-7] How did Paul describe the wisdom spoken to the mature?
   Paul said that it was unlike the wisdom of those who pass away. Instead, God had planned this hidden wisdom long ago for the glory of believers.

2. [2:8] If the rulers of that time had understood this wisdom, what would they have done differently?
   They would not have crucified the Lord of glory.

3. [2:9] In verse 9, Paul quoted Isaiah 64:4, which is a verse in the Old Testament. What does that verse say that no one can imagine?
   No one can imagine what God has planned for those who love him.

4. [2:10] How did Paul and other believers know the things that God prepared for them?
   God revealed those things to them through the Spirit.

5. [2:11] Who knows the deep things of God?
   Only the Spirit of God knows the deep things of God.

6. [2:12] What do believers receive instead of the spirit of the world?
   They receive the Spirit who is from God.

1 Corinthians 2:6-16 continued

7. [2:12] Why does God give his Spirit to believers?
   God gives his Spirit so that believers can know the things that are freely given to them by God.

8. [2:13] What kind of words are used to teach spiritual truths?
   Words taught by the Spirit of God are used to teach spiritual truths.

9. [2:14] What do people who do not have the Spirit of God think about spiritual truths?
   Spiritual truths seem like foolishness to them.

10. [2:14] Why are unspiritual people unable to understand spiritual truths?
    They cannot understand because these truths must be spiritually understood.

11. [2:15] What can the spiritual person do?
    The spiritual person can judge all things.

12. [2:16] Whose mind do believers have?
    Believers have the mind of Christ.

Comment Section:

3:10-17

Background: In this passage, Paul wrote directly to his readers, who were believers in Jesus Christ. When Paul said something is true about “you” in this passage, he meant that it is true about each believer who reads this letter to the Corinthians.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Jesus Christ is the foundation of the church. [3:10-11]
- ☐ Anyone who builds on this foundation will have their work tested by fire. [3:12-13]
- ☐ If a person’s work survives the test, they will be rewarded. [3:14]
- ☐ If a person’s work is burned up, they will suffer loss, but that person will still be saved. [3:15]
- ☐ The believer is the temple of the Holy Spirit. [3:16-17]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [3:10] What did Paul do according to the grace of God?
   Paul laid the foundation.

2. [3:11] Who is the only foundation that someone can lay?
   Jesus Christ is the only foundation.

3. [3:10-11] What do you think Paul meant when he wrote that he laid the foundation, who is Jesus Christ?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps this meant that Paul preached the gospel of Jesus Christ to them, which is the foundation of the Christian faith. Without Jesus Christ, the church does not exist. Paul may have also meant that everything he taught them was founded on the message of Jesus Christ.

4. [3:12-13] What will happen to the work of someone who builds on the foundation of Jesus Christ?
   The work will be revealed in daylight, and fire will test the quality of the work.

5. [3:14] What will happen if a person’s work survives the fire?
   That person will receive a reward.

6. [3:15] What did Paul write about the person whose work is burned?
   Paul wrote that such a person will suffer loss, but the person will be saved, escaping the fire.

7. [3:16] What did Paul ask the Corinthian believers in verse 16?
   Paul asked whether they knew that the believer is the temple of the Holy Spirit. He asked whether they knew that the Holy Spirit dwells in each believer.

1 Corinthians 3:10-17 continued

8. [3:17] What did Paul say would happen to someone who destroys God's temple?
   God would destroy that person.

9. [3:17] Who is God's holy temple, according to verse 17?
   The believer is God's holy temple.

Comment Section:

3:18-23

Background: In this passage, Paul continued to write to the believers of Corinth about their divisions over which human Christian leader to follow. When this passage has the words “it is written,” this means that Paul is quoting scripture verses from the Old Testament.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul told believers not to deceive themselves. He told those who considered themselves as wise to become fools in order to gain wisdom. [3:18]
- ☐ This is because the world’s wisdom is foolishness to God. [3:19-20]
- ☐ Paul told believers not to boast in men. [3:21]
- ☐ Everything belongs to believers, because believers all belong to Christ, and Christ belongs to God. [3:21-23]

Part 2

1. [3:18] What did Paul tell the believers not to do in verse 18?
   He told them not to deceive themselves.

2. [3:18] What did Paul say to those who considered themselves as wise in the eyes of the world?
   He told them to become fools so that they could gain wisdom.

3. [3:19] What is the wisdom of the world to God?
   It is foolishness.

4. [3:20] What does the Lord know about the thoughts of these kinds of “wise” people?
   Their thoughts are futile.

5. [3:21] What did Paul tell the believers not to do in verse 21?
   He told them not to boast in men.

6. [3:21-22] Why do you think Paul told the believers that all things belong to them?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps he meant that there were no secret or hidden teachings from Christian leaders, or about anything else, that should separate one group from another group.

7. [3:23] Who do all believers belong to?
   They belong to Christ.

8. [3:23] Who does Christ belong to?
   He belongs to God the Father.

Comment Section:

4:1-5

Background: In this passage, when Paul used the word “we,” he was speaking for himself along with the other teachers of the gospel.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul said that he and his fellow teachers of the gospel should be regarded as stewards of God’s hidden truths. [4:1]
- ☐ Stewards must be trustworthy. [4:2]
- ☐ Paul did not consider humans’ judgments about him to be important. He said that the Lord judged him. [4:3-4]
- ☐ Paul wrote that the Lord is the judge and will bring hidden things and motives of the heart into the light. [4:5]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [4:1] How did Paul say that people should regard Paul and his companions?
   People should regard them as servants of Christ and stewards of the hidden truths of God.

2. [4:2] What did Paul say was required of stewards?
   Paul said that stewards must be trustworthy, or faithful.

3. [4:3-4] What did Paul think of human judgment about him?
   Paul did not think that other people’s judgment of him was important. He said that he did not even judge himself.

4. [4:5] What did Paul say about judgment in verse 5?
   He told his readers that they should judge nothing before the time when the Lord comes.

5. [4:5] What did Paul say will happen after the Lord comes?
   He said that the Lord will bring to light the hidden things of darkness and will show the purposes of the heart.

6. [4:5] Why do you think humans should judge nothing before the Lord comes?
   (Answer may vary.) Humans do not always know everything about a person or situation. They do not always know another person’s motives or reasons for doing something, so their judgments can be wrong. Only when the Lord comes will the full truth be known. Since the Lord is the judge of all humans, this probably means that people should not be quick to judge others.

Comment Section:

5:6-13

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

☐ Paul told the Corinthians that their boasting was not good. [5:6]

☐ Paul told the Corinthians to stop doing what is evil and to be sincere and truthful. [5:7-8]

☐ Paul told the Corinthians to avoid anyone in the church who is sexually immoral or commits other sins. [5:9-11]

☐ He said that God will judge those outside the church. [5:12-13]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [5:6] What did Paul say the Corinthians were doing that was not good?
   They were boasting.

2. [5:8] To what did Paul compare bad behavior and wickedness?
   Paul compared them to yeast.

3. [5:6-8] Paul said a little yeast leavens the whole loaf. How do you think this shows what sin is like?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps this meant that, just as yeast spreads through dough, so can sinful acts affect everyone in the church or even cause others to sin.

4. [5:9] What kinds of people had Paul told the Corinthians to avoid when he had written to them earlier?
   Paul had told them not to associate with sexually immoral people.

5. [5:10] Did Paul mean for them to avoid all sinful people?
   Paul did not mean that they must avoid all the immoral people of this world. To avoid all sinful people, a Christian would have to go out of the world.

6. [5:11] What people did Paul mean that the Corinthian believers should avoid?
   He meant for them not to associate with anyone who is called a brother or sister in Christ but who is still sexually immoral, greedy, verbally abusive, a drunkard, a swindler, or an idolater.

7. [5:12] What do you think Paul meant by the questions he asked in verse 12?
   He seemed to mean that judgment should be directed within the church, not toward those who are outside the church.

8. [5:13] Who will judge those who are outside the church?
   God will judge them.

Comment Section:

6:12-20

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul said that all things are lawful, but not all things are beneficial. [6:12]
- ☐ He said that the body is not meant for sexual immorality. Instead, the body is meant for the Lord. [6:13]
- ☐ Believers' bodies are parts of Christ's body, but the idea of uniting Christ's body to a prostitute is repellent. [6:15]
- ☐ A man who has sexual relations with a prostitute unites his body to the prostitute's body. [6:16]
- ☐ People who are sexually immoral sin against their own bodies. [6:18]
- ☐ The body of a believer is a temple of the Holy Spirit and belongs to God. [6:19]
- ☐ Believers should glorify God with their bodies. [6:20]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [6:12] What did Paul say in verse 12?
   He said that all things are lawful, but not all things are beneficial.

2. [6:13] What is the body meant for, instead of being meant for sexual immorality?
   It is meant for the Lord.

3. [6:14] What will God do to believers by his power?
   God will raise believers by his power, as he raised the Lord Jesus.

4. [6:14] What do you think Paul meant by the questions he asked in verse 14?
   (Answer may vary.) Paul seemed to mean that, because believers' bodies are parts of Christ's body, believers should hate to consider committing sexual sin as much as they would hate to consider Christ's body becoming united to a prostitute. Believers who defile their own bodies defile the very body of Christ.

5. [6:15-16] When a man has sexual relations with a prostitute, what is he doing with his body?
   He is uniting his body with her body, because scripture says that those who have sexual relations become one flesh with each other.

6. [6:17] What happens to someone who is joined with the Lord?
   That person becomes one spirit with the Lord.

7. [6:18] What does Paul write that believers should do about sexual immorality?
   Believers should run away from it.

8. [6:18] Who do people sin against when they are sexually immoral?
   They sin against their own bodies when they are sexually immoral.

1 Corinthians 6:12-20 continued

9. [6:19-20] Why should believers glorify God with their bodies?
   They should glorify God with their bodies because their bodies are a temple of the Holy Spirit and because they were bought with a price.

10. [6:19-20] What do you think Paul meant when he said that believers were bought with a price?
    Paul seemed to refer to the price that Jesus paid for believers by dying on the cross for them. He indicates that believers therefore do not belong to themselves but instead belong to the one who paid this price for them.

Comment Section:

7:1-7

Background: In this passage, the apostle Paul began to answer a question that the Corinthians had asked him. Paul himself was unmarried. Perhaps because they observed this, the Corinthians had written to him, saying that they thought it must be good for a man not to touch a woman. (This and other phrases Paul used in this passage were ways of referring to sexual relations.) Paul responded to the Corinthians in this passage by writing about some advantages of being married. Later in the book, he wrote about some advantages of being unmarried.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul wrote about sexual relations between a husband and a wife. [7:1-5]
- ☐ He said that a husband has authority over his wife's body, and a wife has authority over her husband's body. [7:4]
- ☐ He said that a husband and wife should only deprive each other if they both agree to do so for a specific or set time period. They should devote themselves to prayer during that time. [7:5]
- ☐ Paul wished that all people could be like him, but he said that everyone has their own gift. [7:6-7]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [7:1-2] Why should each man have his own wife and each woman have her own husband?
   Because of temptations for many immoral acts, each man should have his own wife, and each wife should have her own husband.

2. [7:3] What should a husband and wife do with regard to each other?
   They should fulfill their duty to each other for sexual relations.

3. [7:3] Why do you think Paul wrote about the husband's duty to his wife and the wife's duty to her husband?
   (Answer may vary.) The passage seems to indicate that this is because they should agree with each other in regard to having sexual relations.

4. [7:4] How did Paul describe authority over each of the two bodies within a marriage?
   A husband has authority over his wife's body, and likewise the wife has authority over her husband's body.

5. [7:4-5] What do you think Paul meant when he said that the husband has authority over his wife's body, and that likewise the wife has authority over the husband's body?
   (Answer may vary.) Paul probably meant that when a man and a woman are married, they belong to each other, and their bodies belong to each other. They cannot give their bodies to someone else for sexual relations. They also cannot decide to no longer have sexual relations with their spouse without their spouse's agreement.

6. [7:5] What did Paul write about the husband and wife depriving each other from sexual relations?
   He wrote that this deprivation should be done by mutual agreement, and for a specific period of time.

1 Corinthians 7:1-7 continued

7. [7:5] If they agree to deprive themselves, what did he say that a husband and wife should do instead?
   Paul told them to devote themselves to prayer for this time.

8. [7:5] What was the reason that they should come together again?
   They should come together again (have sexual relations again) so that Satan would not tempt them out of a lack of self-control.

9. [7:6-7] What did Paul express as his own desire (not as God's desire) for Christians regarding marriage?
   Paul wished that they were all unmarried like he was. But he knew that all had different gifts and all would not be able to live as he did.

Comment Section:

8:1-8

Background: The Corinthians were concerned about whether to eat food that was sold in their marketplace because it may have been sacrificed to idols. Paul indicated in this book that there were different ways to think about this issue. This passage is the first way that Paul said that the Corinthians could think about it.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul wrote about love being more important than knowledge, because knowledge can lead to arrogance. [8:1-2]
- ☐ Whoever loves God is known by God. [8:3]
- ☐ Concerning eating food sacrificed to idols, Paul wrote that idols are nothing because there is only one God. [8:4]
- ☐ Christians understand that they have only one God and one Lord Jesus Christ. [8:5-6]
- ☐ Some Christians who worshipped idols in the past might have weak consciences. They might see themselves as defiled if they ate food sacrificed to idols. [8:7]
- ☐ Food cannot make people more acceptable to God or less acceptable to God. [8:8]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [8:1] What subject did Paul begin to address in this chapter?
   Paul began to address the subject of food sacrificed to idols.

2. [8:1] What results do knowledge and love cause?
   Knowledge puffs up, but love builds up.

3. [8:1] What do you think it means that knowledge puffs up, but love builds up?
   This indicates that knowledge can make a person prideful, but love helps other people.

4. [8:2] What did Paul write about the person who thinks he knows something?
   He wrote that if someone thinks that he knows something, that person does not know as he should.

5. [8:3] What did Paul write about the person who loves God?
   He wrote that the person who loves God is known by God.

6. [8:4] What did Paul say about idols in this world and God?
   An idol in this world is nothing. There is only one God.

7. [8:5-6] What did Paul say is true for Christians, even if there were so-called gods?
   Even if there were so-called gods, for Christians there is only one God, who is the Father, and one Lord Jesus Christ.

1 Corinthians 8:1-8 continued

8. [8:7] What might happen to some believers who previously worshipped idols, if they ate food sacrificed to an idol?
   They might think, as they ate the food, that they truly were doing an act of worship to another god. Since their conscience was weak, they might feel shame for having eaten the meat.

9. [8:8] What did Paul say was true about food in verse 8?
   Food is not how people present themselves to God. People are not worse if they eat it. People are not better if they eat it.

Comment Section:

9:24-27

Background: In Paul's country at the time when he lived, wreaths were given as prizes to athletes who won games and races. A wreath is a bunch of leaves twisted together, and the winner of a race would wear the wreath on his head like a crown. In this passage, Paul speaks about eternal life as if it were a wreath that would never dry up.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

☐ Paul wrote about the Christian life as if it were like running a race. [9:24]

☐ Paul wrote that Christians run to receive a wreath that will last forever. [9:25]

☐ Paul described how he used self-control so that he would not be disqualified. [9:26-27]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [9:24] What did Paul write about running the race and winning the prize?
   He wrote that all runners run the race, but only one receives the prize.

2. [9:24-25] Why do you think Paul used the example of athletic training to describe the Christian life?
   (Answer may vary.) He probably did this because, like athletes, Christians must have discipline and self-control to achieve their goals.

3. [9:25] What kind of wreath do Christians run to receive?
   Christians run to receive a wreath that will not perish.

4. [9:26] What did Paul say in verse 26 about how he lived his Christian life?
   He did not act like a runner without any goal or aim. He did not act like a boxer who only hit the air with his fists.

5. [9:27] Why did Paul subdue his body and make it a slave?
   Paul made his body a slave so that after he had preached to others, he would not be disqualified.

Comment Section:

10:14-22

Background: The Corinthians were concerned about whether to eat food that was sold in their marketplace because it may have been sacrificed to idols. Paul indicated in this book that there were different ways to think about this issue.

In earlier passages, Paul wrote that because there is only one God, it is meaningless when food is sacrificed to idols. But Paul had warned that new believers who previously worshipped idols might not understand this. Paul had talked to those believers in that passage, to teach them the truth about idols.

In this passage, however, Paul addressed those Corinthians who had not completely left behind their old practices of idol worship in order to worship only the true God. Here Paul wrote again that idols cannot be true gods, but idols can represent demons.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul told the Corinthians to run away from idolatry. [10:14]
- ☐ Paul called communion a sharing in the body and blood of Christ. [10:16]
- ☐ He said that believers are like the one bread they share. They are one body. [10:17]
- ☐ In the past, when the people of Israel ate sacrifices, they participated in the altar of God. [10:18]
- ☐ Paul did not mean to say that idols are anything or that food sacrificed to idols is anything. [10:19]
- ☐ However, foods offered to idols could be offerings to demons. Christians should not participate with demons. [10:20]
- ☐ Paul warned Christians that they will provoke the Lord to jealousy if they participate with demons. [10:21-22]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [10:14] What did Paul warn the Corinthian believers to run away from?
   He warned them to run away from idolatry.

2. [10:15] What kind of people did Paul write that he was speaking to?
   He wrote that he was speaking to them as people who had understanding.

3. [10:16] What is the cup of blessing that the believers bless, and what is the bread that they break?
   The cup is a sharing in the blood of Christ. The bread is a sharing in the body of Christ.

4. [10:17] Because there is one loaf of bread, what did Paul say about himself and the many other Christians?
   He said that they are one body because they take and eat from one loaf of bread together.

5. [10:18-19] What questions did Paul ask the Corinthians?
   He asked them if an idol or food offered to idols was anything to be concerned about.

1 Corinthians 10:14-22 continued

6. [10:19] Why do you think Paul asked them these questions?
   Paul seemed to know that his readers would understand that the answer to these questions would be “no” (especially after they had read the earlier passages about this issue). Paul used these questions to emphasize to the readers that he did not believe that the idols were real gods.

7. [10:20] What happens when idol worshippers offer their sacrifices?
   They offer sacrifices to demons and not to God.

8. [10:21] Since Paul did not want the Corinthian believers to be participants with demons, what did he tell them that they cannot do?
   Paul told them that they cannot drink the cup of the Lord and the cup of demons. They cannot have fellowship at the table of the Lord and fellowship at the table of demons.

9. [10:22] What will believers do if they participate with demons?
   They will cause the Lord to be jealous.

Comment Section:

11:23-34

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul described the taking of the bread and the cup to remember Jesus' death. [11:23-26]
- ☐ Paul warned that those who receive the bread or cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner bring judgment on themselves. [11:27-30]
- ☐ Those partaking of the Lord's supper should examine themselves. [11:31]
- ☐ Those judged by the Lord are disciplined so they will not be condemned. [11:32]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [11:23] What had Paul delivered to the Corinthians?
   Paul delivered to them what he had received from the Lord.

2. [11:24] On the night that he was betrayed, what did the Lord say after he broke the bread?
   Jesus said, "This is my body, which is for you." Jesus then told them to do this as a way of remembering him.

3. [11:25] What did the Lord say when he took the cup after supper?
   Jesus said, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood." Jesus then told them to do this, as often as they would drink it, as a way of remembering him.

4. [11:26] What are believers doing every time they eat this bread and drink this cup?
   They are proclaiming the Lord's death until he returns.

5. [11:27, 29] Why should no one eat the bread or drink the cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner?
   Eating the bread or drinking the cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner makes people guilty of sinning against the body and blood of the Lord. People who do this are eating and drinking judgment on themselves.

6. [11:28] What did Paul write that people should do before taking the bread and the cup?
   Paul wrote that people should examine themselves first.

7. [11:30] What happened to many among the Corinthian church who ate the bread and drank the cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner?
   Many among them became sick and ill. Some of them died.

8. [11:31] What did Paul say would happen if people examine themselves?
   He said that they would not be judged.

9. [11:32] How did Paul describe what happens when people are judged by the Lord?
   He said that people are disciplined so that they may not be condemned along with the world.

1 Corinthians 11:23-34 continued

10. [11:33] What did Paul instruct the Corinthians to do when they came together to eat?
    Paul told them to wait for each other.

11. [11:34] What did Paul tell them to do if they were hungry, so that they would not come under judgment?
    Paul told them to eat something at home first.

12. [11:34] Why do you think that Paul told the Corinthians that he would give them further directions when he came to them?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps the Corinthians had written about many other matters, and these were the most important ones. Perhaps Paul had more details to discuss with them, but he wanted to get to his next subject. Perhaps there were other difficult matters with the Corinthians that Paul wanted to address in person.

Comment Section:

12:12-31

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ As the body is one with many members, so it is in Christ. [12:12, 14, 20]
- ☐ All were baptized in one Spirit into one body: Jews or Gentiles, slaves or free. [12:13]
- ☐ No part of the body can say that it does not need another part of the body. What each part of the body does is important. [12:15-17, 21-25]
- ☐ Members of the body should be united in care for each other. [12:23-25]
- ☐ If one member suffers, all members suffer. If one member rejoices, all members rejoice. [12:26]
- ☐ In the body of Christ, God has appointed members to serve in different ways, not all in the same way. [12:27-30]
- ☐ Paul wrote that he was going to show them a more excellent way. [12:31]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [12:12-26] In this passage, what did Paul say about the human body?
   The human body is one and is made up of many parts, and each part serves the body in its own way.

2. [12:12-26] In this passage, how did Paul explain how this idea about the human body related to the church?
   The body of Christ, the church, should also be united (as one), even though it is made up of many parts. Each person should serve the body of Christ, the church, in his or her unique way.

3. [12:13] How did Paul describe the unity of the believers?
   All believers are baptized into one body because all are given the same Spirit.

4. [12:27-31] How did Paul explain what he meant by believers being the body of Christ?
   All people who believe in Christ are one in Him, but each person has their own way of serving Christ. Each way of serving is valuable and needed.

5. [12:28-29] What examples did Paul give for ways that people serve Christ?
   The Lord gave apostles, prophets, teachers, miracle workers, healing people, people who help others, works of administration, and those who speak in different tongues.

6. [12:28, 30, 31] What do you think Paul meant by the gifts in these verses?
   The text indicates that he meant spiritual abilities or special abilities from the Holy Spirit or special spiritual skills that God gives.

Comment Section:

13:4-13

Background: In the previous chapter, after talking about spiritual gifts in the church, Paul said that he was going to show the Corinthians a more excellent way. Just before this passage, Paul talked about how useless any important-seeming gifts were without love. In this passage, Paul explains what kind of love he means.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Love is patient and kind. It is not boastful or arrogant. [13:4]
- ☐ Love is not selfish, easily angered, or unforgiving. [13:5]
- ☐ Love delights in what is good and true. [13:6]
- ☐ Love endures all things with hope. [13:7]
- ☐ Love does not end. But many other gifts will end. [13:8]
- ☐ When completeness comes, all incomplete things will pass away. [13:9-10, 12]
- ☐ When Paul became an adult, he put away childish things. [13:11]
- ☐ Paul said that only faith, hope, and love will remain. But the greatest of these is love. [13:12-13]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [13:4-5] How does Paul describe love in verses 4 and 5?
   It is patient and kind. It does not envy or boast. It is not arrogant or rude. It is not selfish. It is not easily angered, and it does not keep a record of how it has been wronged.

2. [13:6] How does love react to what is evil and what is true?
   Love does not rejoice in what is evil. Love delights in what is true.

3. [13:7] How does Paul describe love in verse 7?
   Love endures and bears all things. Love believes and hopes all things.

4. [13:8] What are some things that will pass away or cease?
   Prophecies, tongues, and knowledge will cease.

5. [13:8] What will never end?
   Love will never end.

6. [13:9] What do you think Paul meant when he wrote that we know in part and we prophesy in part?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps he meant that what we know and prophesy is limited, or that we do not know everything. Perhaps he meant that everything will be fully known and fulfilled only in heaven or when Jesus returns.

1 Corinthians 13:4-13 continued

7. [13:10] What will come that will make everything incomplete pass away?
   The perfect will come.

8. [13:10] What do you think Paul means when he says that the perfect will come?
   Paul probably meant that there will be a time when what people know will be made complete or perfect. This could refer to when believers enter their eternal life in heaven, or it could refer to when Jesus returns to the earth.

9. [13:11] What changed when Paul became an adult?
   When he became an adult, Paul stopped behaving like a child.

10. [13:12] What did Paul compare with knowing in part, which believers experience now?
    Paul compared it to looking at something indirectly in a mirror.

11. [13:13] Paul stated three things that remain and one was the greatest. What were those things?
    Paul said faith, hope, and love remain, and love is the greatest.

Comment Section:

14:20-25

Background: In this passage, Paul wrote about speaking in other tongues. Paul was referring to a spiritual gift that causes a person to speak in a spiritual or heavenly language. A message spoken in this spiritual or heavenly language can only be interpreted by someone with a specific spiritual gift. In contrast, prophecy is also a message from God that a person speaks, but prophecy is spoken in an understandable (human) language.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Paul told the Corinthians to be mature in their thinking. [14:20]
- ☐ Paul said that tongues are a sign for unbelievers, but prophecy is a sign for believers. [14:21-22]
- ☐ Unbelievers who hear a group of church members speaking in tongues will not understand what is being said. They might then think that the believers are out of their minds. [14:23]
- ☐ An unbeliever who hears a group of church members prophesying may instead be convicted. [14:24]
- ☐ That person might then believe and worship God. [14:25]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [14:20] What did Paul write about the maturity of the Corinthians in verse 20?
   He told them to stop thinking like children. Regarding evil, they should be like infants. In their thinking, they should be mature.

2. [14:21-22] After Paul quoted an Old Testament prophecy in verse 21, for what people did he say that tongues and prophesying are a sign?
   Paul said that tongues are a sign to unbelievers and that prophesying is a sign for believers.

3. [14:23] What did Paul think that outsiders and unbelievers might say if they came among a group of church members who were all speaking in tongues?
   Paul said that the outsiders would probably say that the believers were out of their minds.

4. [14:24] What did Paul say could happen if all the church members were prophesying and an unbeliever or an outsider came in among them?
   Paul said that the unbeliever or outsider could be convicted and judged by hearing the prophecy.

5. [14:25] What could happen if the words of the prophecy revealed the secrets of the unbeliever's heart?
   The unbeliever might then fall down, worship God, and declare that God was really among the believers.

Comment Section:

15:20-28

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in these verses.

- ☐ Christ was the first one to be raised from the dead. [15:20]
- ☐ Because of one man, Adam, all people must die. Because of one man, Christ, all believers will be raised from the dead. [15:21-22]
- ☐ Christ was raised first. Next, all believers will be raised when Christ returns. Then the end will come. [15:23-24]
- ☐ Christ must reign until he has destroyed all enemies, including death. [15:25-26]
- ☐ When all things are under Jesus Christ, then Jesus Christ will also be under God the Father, who will be all in all. [15:27-28]

Part 2

Answer the following questions.

1. [15:20] What has happened to Christ?
   Christ has been raised from the dead.

2. [15:20] What do you think Paul meant when he wrote that Christ is the firstfruits of those who died?
   (Answer may vary.) This could refer to the Old Testament feast of firstfruits, when the first things that were harvested, or the first animals that were born, were offered to God in gratitude and to show faith that more good things would come. By saying that Christ was the firstfruits of those who died, Paul probably meant that Christ was the first one to be raised from the dead, and that Christ's resurrection showed that more people (the believers who have died) will also be raised from the dead.

3. [15:21-22] What did Paul say in verses 21 and 22 about death and the resurrection from the dead?
   Death came because of one man, Adam. The resurrection from the dead came because of another man, Jesus Christ.

4. [15:22] What do you think it means to be in Adam and to be in Christ?
   (Answer may vary.) To be in Adam probably means to be like Adam, because all people are his descendants, because all people sin, and because all people deserve death like Adam did. To be in Christ probably means to be united in Christ by faith, which makes it possible to be raised from death like Christ is.

5. [15:22] What happens to people who are in Adam, and what will happen to people who are in Christ?
   Everyone who is in Adam must die for their sin. Everyone who is in Christ will be made alive.

6. [15:23] When will those who belong to Christ be made alive?
   Those who belong to Christ will be made alive when Christ comes.

7. [15:24] What will happen at the end?
   Christ will give the kingdom to God the Father after every other rule, authority, and power has been destroyed.

1 Corinthians 15:20-28 continued

8. [15:25] Who will reign at that time?
   Christ will reign.

9. [15:25] What do you think that Paul meant when he wrote that Jesus must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet?
   This indicates that Jesus will reign until he has defeated all his enemies.

10. [15:26] What is the last enemy to be destroyed?
    Death is the last enemy to be destroyed.

11. [15:27] In verse 27, who is not included in all that was put under Christ's feet?
    God, who put everything under Christ, is not included.

12. [15:27] What do you think that Paul meant when he said that all things that are put under Christ's feet?
    This indicates that everything will be put under Christ's authority, or that God the Father will make Christ rule over everything.

13. [15:28] What will happen when all things are subjected under the Son?
    The Son will be under the Father's authority.

14. [15:28] Who do you think this Son is?
    The Father is God, and the Son is capitalized, which means the Son of God, who is Jesus Christ.

Comment Section: